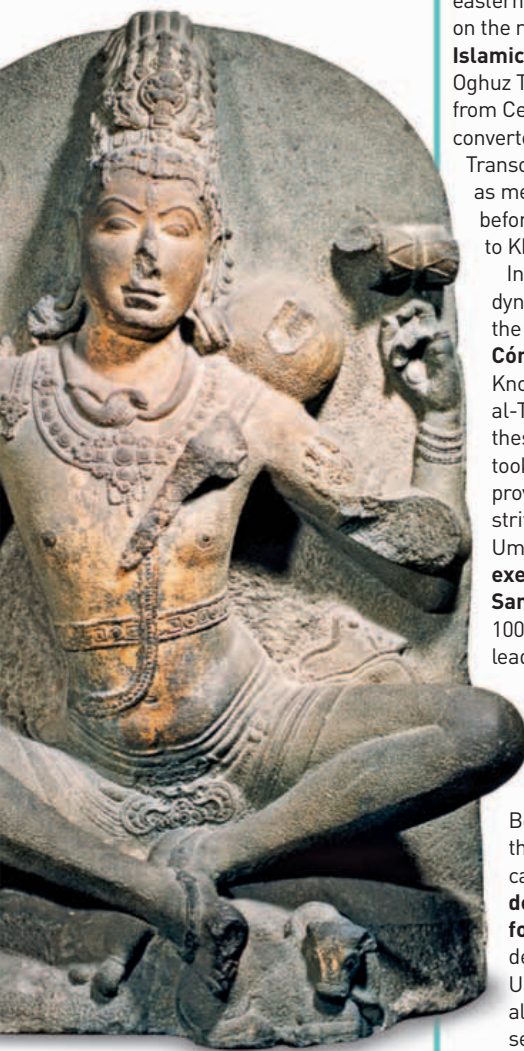


1031 – 1040



A wise and capable king, Cnut managed conciliation between his Danish and Anglo-Saxon subjects. He collected Danegeld (Danish tax) to pay for a standing navy and army—an important innovation.



The Seljuks are shown here battling the Byzantines, having already conquered Persia.

IN 1037, THE SELJUKS, UNDER CHAGRI BEG AND HIS BROTHER TUGHRIL BEG, invaded Khurasan in Persia. In 1040, they crushed the Ghaznavids at the Battle of Dandanqan, winning control of eastern Persia, the first step on the road to creating a **new Islamic empire**. The Seljuks were Oghuz Turks, originally nomads from Central Asia who had converted to Islam and moved to Transoxiana, where they served as mercenaries in the region, before turning their attentions to Khurasan.

In 1031, 40 lesser dynasties were founded on the shattered remnants of the **Córdoba caliphate**, in Spain. Known as the **Muluk al-Tawa'if** ("Party Kings"), these short-lived dynasties took control of different provinces of Córdoba after the strife that brought down the Umayyads following the **execution of Abd al-Rahman Sanchol**, son of al-Mansur, in 1009. He was the last capable leader of the caliphate, but his attempt to move out from behind the throne and take the crown led to his downfall. Subsequently, the Berber faction nominated their own candidate for caliph and **Córdoba descended into civil war for 22 years**. In 1031, the death of Hisham III, the last Umayyad caliph, who had already lost control of several provinces, led to the



King and Emperor
Ferdinand I was the first ruler of Castile to call himself king. He added the title of emperor after his conquest of León.

final breakup of the caliphate, with the **Abbadids** seizing Seville, the **Jahwarids** taking Córdoba, and the **Hudids** seizing Saragossa. With the **Islamic state in disarray**, the Christian kingdoms to the north were encouraged to expand southward.

Sancho III of Navarre, who had conquered Castile and was overlord of Christian Spain, died in 1035, and his kingdoms were divided between his two sons.

Ferdinand inherited Castile, and in 1037 he killed his brother-in-law, the king of León, and made himself emperor there in 1039. He went on to conquer Navarre and impose serfdom on parts of Muslim Spain and Portugal.

1041 – 1050



Between 1041 and 1048, Bi Sheng invented the first movable type printing system, using clay letters held in wax within an iron frame.

BANTU IS A FAMILY OF LANGUAGES that originated in the Bantu homeland (now southern Nigeria and northwestern Cameroon). Bantu-speaking people spread from here to the east and south and Bantu became the **dominant language family in sub-Saharan Africa**, although whether this indicates conquest, colonization, or simply cultural influence is less clear. The Bantu expansion started in the Late Stone Age, accelerating as the Bantu-speakers acquired iron technology and cattle-husbandry skills. By the mid-11th century, Bantu tribes had become **sophisticated pastoralists**, able to sustain high population densities and complex social and economic networks. This in turn led to the emergence of chiefdoms, and Bantu speakers dominated Central and southern Africa.

In 1044, Anawrata seized power in the **Pagan kingdom in Burma**. His military prowess and skillful

use of Hinayana Buddhism as a cultural and political driver made Pagan the center of Burmese politics, culture, and religion. He developed Burmese as a written language, instituted a program of building, and forged trade and cultural links to India and China.

In China, sometime between 1041 and 1048, the commoner Bi (or Pi) Sheng invented the **first movable type system**. Block printing had been in use in China for centuries, and since the Later Tang dynasty (923–36) had been used for most book production, but Bi Sheng introduced the innovation of using **tiny clay blocks**—one for each character. The characters were molded on the ends of thin rods of wet clay, which were fired to harden them. Unlike wood, this clay type did not distort when wet and could be used over and over again.

KEY

- Bantu homeland 2000 BCE
- Spread of Bantu

Bantu expansion

From their homeland in the border region of southern Nigeria and northwestern Cameroon, Bantu-speaking people spread east and south, through the tropical forest, eventually spreading to all parts of central and southern Africa.



1025 Cholas sack Srivijaya and establish a maritime empire

1025 Death of Basil II (b. 958)

1029 Cholas are expelled from Sri Lanka

1030 Cnut's empire expands to include Denmark and Norway

1028 Sancho III unites Navarre and Castile

1030 Death of Mahmud of Ghazni (b. 971)

1031 Breakup of the Córdoba caliphate

1031 Ferdinand becomes King of Castile

1035 William (the Conqueror) becomes Duke of Normandy

1035 Death of Cnut the Great (born c. 985)

1037 Seljuk Turks invade Khurasan (Persia)

1037 Rouen Cathedral constructed

1037 Ferdinand conquers León

1038 Seljuks conquer against the Northern Song

1039 Henry III elected emperor

1040 King Duncan killed by Macbeth in Scotland

c. 1040 Bantu expansion climaxes in South Africa

1042 Edward the Confessor becomes king of England

1042 Byzantine emperor Michael V deposed, blinded, and succeeded by Theodora and Zoe; period of intrigue and instability in Byzantine Empire

1044 Rise of Pagan kingdom in Burma under Anawrata

1044 Earliest recorded recipe for gunpowder in China

1045 Movable type invented in China

1046 After Benedict IX sells the papacy, Henry III oversees the Deposition of the Three Popes

1048 Seljuk Turks sack Erzerum in Anatolia

1050 Seljuk Turks conquer Isfahan

c. 1050 Mabinogion (book of Welsh legends) is compiled